DAY 11 | PRE-READ

Showing the Right Thing

A light read before Day 11. About 15 minutes, no code required.

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Why read this?

On Day 10 you built screens from components. Today those screens come alive with real data from your own API. You will also learn to show the right thing at the right moment, and one rule that protects every app that uses AI: secret keys never go to the browser.

1. Screens change with the situation

A food delivery app shows a "Log in" button when you are logged out and your name when you are logged in. It shows "Your cart is empty" when there is nothing in it. Choosing what to show based on the data is called **conditional rendering**.

2. One template, many items

A shop with 500 products does not design 500 cards. It designs one card and repeats it for each product. Each item needs a unique label, called a **key**, so React can keep track of which card is which, like roll numbers in a class.

3. Waiting politely

Situation	What a good app shows
Data is on its way	A loading message or spinner
Something went wrong	A clear error and a way to try again
Nothing to show yet	A friendly empty message with a next step
Data has arrived	The actual content

Key idea: every screen has at least four states. Great apps design all four, not just the happy one.

4. Keys belong in the safe, not on the shop window NEW (v4)

Many services, including AI services, give you a secret **API key**. Whoever has the key can use the service and you pay the bill. Everything sent to a browser can be read by the person using it, so a key placed in front-end code is like taping the safe's key to the shop window. The key stays on your server; the browser asks your server, and your server asks the service.

5. Two halves of one app

The React screen runs in the user's browser. The FastAPI back end runs on a server. They talk by sending JSON over HTTP. Browsers are careful about which websites may talk to which servers; the server must say "yes, this website may call me". That permission is called **CORS**.

6. Think about these before class

- Find an app screen that shows a loading state. Was it helpful or annoying?
- What should a support dashboard show when there are no tickets?
- If you could open any website's code in your browser, what should you never find there?

Omotenashi (おもてなし): wholehearted hospitality, anticipating what the guest needs